



THL 4490-005 Solidarity and Peacebuilding in Central and Eastern Europe

Spring 2026

Instructor: Gerald J. Beyer, Ph.D.

Class Meetings: M, W 1:55PM-3:10PM in Vasey 205

Office Hours: T 3:30PM-4:30PM and F 3-4PM on Zoom (please email in advance) or by appointment via Zoom

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Course Description

Although The Polish *Solidarność* movement blossomed in the 1980's, it was essentially born at the 1945 Yalta conference according to Oxford historian Timothy Garton Ash. Most Poles saw Yalta as a betrayal by "the West" that forced Stalinism upon them and a fateful partitioning of Europe that usurped their freedom and heritage.¹ Yalta cordoned Poland and other Soviet satellite states into "Eastern Europe" (sometimes called "Central Eastern Europe") or what Czech writer Milan Kundera dubbed the "kidnapped West."² Throughout the twentieth century, "Eastern European" connoted "second class" or "uncivilized territory."³ Even worse, many people in "the West" continue to see the part of Southeastern Europe known as "the Balkans" as a place where "primitive peoples" inevitably hate and kill one another, leading the U.S. and Western Europe to disregard the region in their foreign policy agendas.⁴

Living behind the "iron curtain," Poles were subjected to various forms of oppression by the Communist regime. As historian Andrzej Paczkowski states, "Poles...suffered every form of Stalinist terror: the hunt for spies, dekulakization, anticlericalism, national and ethnic 'cleansing,' the Great Purge, the purges of border regions...forced labor, the execution of prisoners of war, and mass deportations of groups of people labeled 'socially dangerous elements.'"⁵ Adam Michnik, who eventually was imprisoned for more than five years and tortured for refusing to sign a declaration of loyalty to the regime, thus described life under Communism: "We participated in

¹ Timothy Garton Ash, *The Polish Revolution: Solidarity*. 3rd ed. (New Haven, CT: Yale University Press, 2002), 3-5.

² Milan Kundera, "The Tragedy of Central Europe," *The New York Review of Books*, April 26, 1984.

³ See Timothy Garton Ash, "The Puzzle of Central Europe," *The New York Review of Books*, March 18, 1999 and http://www.newworldencyclopedia.org/entry/Eastern_Europe

⁴ Timothy Garton Ash, "The Puzzle of Central Europe," *The New York Review of Books*, March 18, 1999. See also Jasmin Mujanovic, *Hunger and Fury: The Crisis of Democracy in the Balkans* (Oxford: Oxford Univ. Press, 2018), 3.

⁵ Andrzej Paczkowski, "Poland, the 'Enemy Nation'" in Stephane Coutois et al., *The Black Book of Communism: Crime, Terror, Repression* (Cambridge: Harvard Univ. Press, 1997), 364.

the mock elections, wrote fallacious articles, we raised our hands at absurd meetings, and cheered at organized mass demonstrations in support of the totalitarian system. We did this out of fear, we were deceitful out of fear... ”⁶

During the *Solidarność* era Poles began to “spit out the gag” according to Michnik. They began to openly criticize the lies of the regime: the incarcerations, the deportations, the false promises of economic comfort, the deference to the Soviet Union to the detriment of the Polish nation. “Teachers wanted schools to be real schools, universities to be universities, books to be books,” claimed *Solidarność* chaplain Fr. Jozef Tischner.⁷

This course will introduce students to the context of Poland under Communism in which *Solidarność* arose and the ethic of solidarity embodied in the Polish nonviolent revolution of the 1980’s. It will examine the ethical foundation, normative goals, the influence of Catholicism and the practical methods of the movement. The course will also consider the degree to which the values and principles of *Solidarność* (i.e. the ethic of solidarity) influenced the construction a democratic, capitalist country during Poland’s transition after 1989. Although *Solidarność* had egalitarian moral and political impulses, womens’ voices were marginalized according to some of the sources we will use. We will also discuss how neoliberal capitalism eroded the egalitarian spirit of *Solidarność* and created new forms of oppression and marginalization (based on class, gender and sexual orientation) in capitalist, democratic Poland and the Catholic Church’s failure to confront them,.

While the Polish experience of Communism and *Solidarność* provides the foundation for the course, we will also examine the ongoing challenges to building peace and solidarity in another historically marginalized part of Europe, “the Balkans.” We will examine the case of the Bosnian war, which revealed the lack of European solidarity (a value enshrined in the E.U. constitution) and the failure of the United States to exercise solidarity – yet again – with a people attacked by a genocidal regime. We will study why ethnic and religious groups, especially Bosnian Muslims, were demonized and targeted during the Bosnian war. We will also consider contemporary peacebuilding efforts in Bosnia and Herzegovina aimed at overcoming ethnic, religious and political divisions amidst difficult political and economic circumstances. This examination will highlight the vital contribution of women to the peacebuilding process, and consider what forms of solidarity from other nations might be beneficial as the 25th anniversary of the Srebrenica massacre approaches.

We will also discuss the ongoing war in Ukraine, examining its causes and ethical evaluations of the war. We will also have the honor and privilege of guest lecturers and students from the Ukrainian Catholic University in Lviv joining us for some of our class sessions via Zoom. Ласкаво просимо (“Welcome”) to our Ukrainian colleagues!

This course fulfills the CLAS requirements for diversity courses (“Diversity 3: Courses focus on the culture, economics, politics or ecology of societies and nations other than those of Western Europe and the United States and that emphasize power, privilege, and marginalization or a critical analysis of how these cultures define and express themselves.”)

⁶ Adam Michnik, “The Moral and Spiritual Origins of Solidarity,” 240.

⁷ Tischner, *Etyka solidarności oraz homo sovieticus*, 11.

Required Texts (available in the bookstore)

Ost, David. *The Defeat of Solidarity: Anger and Politics in Postcommunist Europe*. Ithaca, N.Y.: Cornell University Press, 2005. ISBN: 0801473438 (pbk.) Available at <https://www-jstor-org.ezpl.villanova.edu/stable/10.7591/j.ctv2n7jrt>

Weigel, George. *The Final Revolution: The Resistance Church and the Collapse of Communism*. New York: Oxford University Press, 2003. ISBN 0195166647 (pbk.) Available at <http://ezproxy.villanova.edu/login?URL=https://ebookcentral.proquest.com/lib/villanova-ebooks/detail.action?docID=431364>

Michael Anthony Sells. *The Bridge Betrayed: Religion and Genocide in Bosnia*. Berkeley: University of California Press, 1998. ISBN: 0520216628 (pbk.) Available at <http://ezproxy.villanova.edu/login?URL=http://search.ebscohost.com/login.aspx?direct=true&db=nlebk&AN=9229&site=ehost-live&scope=site>

On Electronics reserve (Blackboard):

Gerald J. Beyer, *Recovering Solidarity: Lessons from Poland's Unfinished Revolution* (University of Notre Dame Press, 2010). Available at <http://ebookcentral.proquest.com/lib/villanova-ebooks/detail.action?docID=3441043>

Weigel, George. *The Final Revolution: The Resistance Church and the Collapse of Communism*. New York: Oxford University Press, 2003. ISBN 0195166647 (pbk.) Available at <http://ezproxy.villanova.edu/login?URL=https://ebookcentral.proquest.com/lib/villanova-ebooks/detail.action?docID=431364>

Zilka Spahić Šiljak *Shining Humanity: Life Stories of Women in Bosnia and Herzegovina* (Cambridge Scholars, 2014). ISBN: 9781443867412 (e-book). Available at <https://ebookcentral.proquest.com/lib/villanova-ebooks/detail.action?docID=1790937>

***Readings marked with an asterisk below are posted on blackboard and/or linked with stable URLs.**

N.B. recommended reading are for your reference and are not required.

Course Objectives

1. Students will be able to identify the various kinds of ethical thought pertaining to economic and political life and will be able to apply those modes of thought to concrete issues.

2. Students will become knowledgeable about the ethic of solidarity in the Polish context, understand its significance for the political, economic and social spheres and see its relationship to the broader tradition of Catholic social thought.
3. Students will gain an understanding of the multiple causes of the war in Bosnia (economic, political, and religious) and efforts to build a sustainable peace in Bosnia and Herzegovina today.
3. Students will develop their ability to comprehend and critique texts important for the evaluation of socioeconomic phenomena and political issues from an ethical perspective.
4. Students will gain greater facility in expressing ethical judgments pertaining to concrete socioeconomic and political issues in discussion and written form.
5. Students will develop their ability to do independent research and to present the data in an engaging way to an audience.
6. Students will learn to lead discussion and analysis of academic texts and ideas among their peers.
7. Students will understand the importance of contextual analysis to ethical evaluation and theological thinking.
8. Students will develop skills to analyze challenges to building a society of solidarity across different historical, cultural, political, economic and cultural contexts.
9. Students will gain an appreciation for the “complexity of power relations across and within varying cultures” (CLAS Diversity Core)

Course Requirements

Each of the following items is designed to facilitate achieving the learning outcomes (course goals) described above:

1. Attendance & Participation (20% of final grade): Attendance is mandatory and will be taken at the outset of each class. Five absences will result in a grade of “Y” (failure). Excused absences must be processed through the appropriate college dean’s office (not the instructor, see <https://www1.villanova.edu/villanova/provost/resources/student/policies/attendance.html>). Completion of assigned readings before each class (unless otherwise noted) and participation in class discussion also contributes positively or negatively to a student’s final grade. Please use the focus questions posted on Blackboard for each session’s readings as a guide to reading the assigned texts.

This grade rubric is used to determine the participation grade:

A = consistent attendance; demonstrates excellent knowledge of the readings and makes significant and creative contributions in the class discussion

B = consistent attendance; demonstrates good knowledge of the readings and makes helpful contributions in the class discussion

C = consistent attendance; makes minimal contributions to the class discussion; demonstrates little knowledge of the readings

D = attendance; little to no participation in the class discussion; demonstrates no knowledge of the readings.

F = more than four absences

From time to time, short in-class writing exercises may be given. These exercises give students a chance to process their ideas and to help facilitate discussion. Students will be asked to respond to a short prompt. Answering the question will require engagement with and understanding of the assigned text for the day. These exercises will be used to help determine the participation grade and will be evaluated as follows:

- √ The response demonstrates an adequate engagement with and understanding of the assigned reading.
- ? The response demonstrates some, but not sufficient engagement with and understanding of the assigned reading.
- The response fails to demonstrate engagement with and understanding of the reading.

In addition, from time to time I will call upon students by randomly choosing a name from a stack of note cards. Research has shown this enables students who may otherwise be reticent but have something to contribute to take an active role in discussion. I will also use group discussion with reporting back to the larger group because pedagogical research shows that peer-to-peer learning is extremely valuable. You will not learn better if I exclusively lecture to you, though I will give brief lectures when appropriate. Much evidence supports the idea behind the ancient Chinese proverb “What I hear, I forget; what I see, I remember, what I do, I understand.” In other words, research demonstrates that students learn best when they are *active* in the process, not passive recipients of information from a teacher or authority figure (Objectives 1, 2, 3, 4, 7).

2. Fishbowl (Podcast) (40% of final grade) In this class, students are encouraged to take ownership of their learning and to become peer conversation partners who can reflect publicly. Thus, over the semester, groups of three students will hold a fishbowl-style discussion over the assigned sources. While all students are responsible for reading the assigned course material, those who will be in the Fishbowl will each prepare by 1) writing 3-4 sentences about the main argument or core themes of the assigned text(s); 2) crafting at least two questions to ask during the Fishbowl; and 3) emailing their sentences and questions to the professor by 12PM in the day before their time to lead.

Once we’re in our class meeting, here’s how it works: The professor will invite the group to begin. Any student in the Fishbowl may start the discussion (again, leaders are encouraged to communicate beforehand) by posing a question. The group should discuss the question before moving on to another question. (The next question might arise organically, or you can say, “Let’s move on.”) Students will be in the Fishbowl for 20-25 minutes while the rest of the class listens in and notes their comments. The professor will also listen during this time. The professor will indicate when time has passed and invite others to join the conversation. Like a podcast, the tone is good-humored, intentional, and spontaneous. By leading, you’re helping others learn. Each participant will contribute to the success of a Fishbowl, but individual participation will also be assessed. Each student will participate in 2 Fishbowls for the semester. A signup sheet will be available on the first day of class for two students to sign up for each session. Extra credit will be given to those who sign up for the earliest sessions!

Rubric: 20 points each = 100 points

- You write and submit to the Blackboard Discussion Board (by noon the day before you

lead) a focused summary of the main argument and supportive points of the text, referring to the author(s) by name (3-5 sentences).

- You write and submit to the Discussion Board (by noon before the day you lead) at least two carefully crafted questions. Questions should be 1) complex (not binary – that is, not calling for a simple yes/no or agree/disagree response). 2) contextualized, and 3) of different types. To contextualize your questions, offer a sentence or two that reflects on some aspect of the text and shows where your question is coming from.
- The group communicates the central argument or ideas of the text(s) they are discussing. This may be done through a brief summary statement or, more preferably, in an opening conversation or in questions that seek to clarify the author's meaning.
- The group helps us to see what is at stake in the question of the text(s) or how it is relevant for us in class today. Constructive and courteous disagreement is an excellent tool for this purpose.
- The conversation flows well, feels organic rather than artificial, and uses the time well.

Letter Grade Four Point Scale Percentage

94-100	A	4.00	≥ 93.3%
90-93	A-	3.67	≥ 90.0%
87-89	B+	3.33	≥ 86.6%
84-86	B	3.00	≥ 83.3%
80-83	B-	2.67	≥ 80.0%
77-79	C+	2.33	≥ 76.6%
74-76	C	2.00	≥ 73.3%
70-73	C-	1.67	≥ 70.0%
67-69	D+	1.33	≥ 66.6%
64-66	D	1.00	≥ 63.3%
60-63	D-	0.67	≥ 60.0%

3. Midterm Analysis Paper (20% of final grade)

These papers will involve close textual analysis of the readings and the appropriation of class lectures and discussion. Students will choose from topics provided by the instructor that deal with various aspects of the course. The papers will be due 2/25. The paper will count for 20% of the final grade. It must be submitted in hard copy at the outset of class on the due date. Papers submitted electronically will not be accepted.

4. Final Exam (20% of final grade): All students must take a written take-home final exam, which will be due at the time designated by the university registrar for the course exam. No exceptions will be made, except under the extreme, documentable circumstances. Students will choose from the essay prompts provided. The final exam requires close reading of assigned texts and the appropriation of class lectures and discussions.

Other Policies and Procedures

Grading Policies: Final grades are assigned in accordance with the Undergraduate Grading System In accordance with the University standards, letter grades are equivalent to the following: A=4.00; A-=3.67; B+=3.33; B=3.00; B-=2.67; C+=2.33; C=2.00; C-=1.67; D+=1.33; D=1.00; D-=.67. In addition, I follow the university's guidelines for grading in all assignments. Thus, an "A" is "[t]he highest academic grade possible; an honor grade which is not automatically given to a student who ranks highest in the course, but is reserved for accomplishment that is truly distinctive and demonstrably outstanding. It represents a superior mastery of course material and is a grade that demands a very high degree of understanding as well as originality or creativity as appropriate to the nature of the course. The grade indicates that the student works independently with unusual effectiveness and often takes the initiative in seeking new knowledge outside the formal confines of the course." (Villanova University catalog, p. 60)

Office for Access & Disability Services (ADS) and Learning Support Services (LSS)

It is the policy of Villanova to make reasonable academic accommodations for qualified individuals with disabilities. All students who need accommodations should go to [Clockwork for Students](#) via myNOVA to complete the Online Intake or to send accommodation letters to professors. Go to the LSS website <http://learningsupportservices.villanova.edu> or the ADS website <https://www1.villanova.edu/university/student-life/ods.html> for registration guidelines and instructions. If you have any questions please contact LSS at 610-519-5176 or learning.support.services@villanova.edu, or ADS at 610-519-3209 or ods@villanova.edu.

Academic Integrity

All students are expected to uphold Villanova's Academic Integrity Policy and Code. Any incident of academic dishonesty will be reported to the Dean of the College of Liberal Arts and Sciences for disciplinary action. You may view the [University's Academic Integrity Policy and Code](#) for a detailed description.

If a student is found responsible for an academic integrity violation, which results in a grade penalty, they may not WX the course unless they are approved to WX for significant medical reasons. Students applying for a WX based on significant medical reasons, must submit documentation and their request for an exception will be considered.

Please note that downloading essays or parts of essays is a violation of academic integrity, as is the use of AI technology. This class is considered an "AI free" zone, so using ChatGPT or similar technology is prohibited.

Absences for Religious Holidays

Villanova University makes every reasonable effort to allow members of the community to observe their religious holidays, consistent with the University's obligations, responsibilities, and policies. Students who expect to miss a class or assignment due to the observance of a religious holiday should discuss the matter with their professors as soon as possible, normally at least two weeks in advance. Absence from classes or examinations for religious reasons does not relieve students from responsibility for any part of the course work required during the absence.

<https://www1.villanova.edu/villanova/provost/resources/student/policies/religiousholidays.html>

Personal Days

In addition to the attendance policy stated above, students are entitled to one excused absence for any reason that may contribute to their personal wellness. Students must advise the instructor by email before class of their intent to utilize a Personal Day as the reason for their absence. A Personal Day will not be approved retroactively. Students may, but are not required, to provide additional information regarding their absence. Additionally, a Personal Day may not:

- be used immediately preceding or following a University holiday or break period;
- be used on days when exams, presentations or other major assignments are scheduled.

A Personal Day does not grant an automatic extension for items due. Students remain responsible for all assignments, exams, presentations, etc. due on that date. It is in the instructor's discretion to determine whether any extension is appropriate given individual circumstances.

Use of Copyrighted Course Materials:

The materials used in Villanova University courses ("Course Materials") generally represent the intellectual property of course instructors, third parties and/or the University which may not be disseminated or reproduced in any form for public distribution (e.g., sale, exchange, etc.) without the written permission of the course instructor. Course Materials include all written or electronic documents and materials, including syllabi, current and past examination questions/answers, and presentations such as lectures, videos, PowerPoints, etc., provided by a course instructor. Course Materials may only be used by students enrolled in the course for academic (course-related) purposes.

Published course readings (book chapters, articles, reports, etc.) available in Blackboard are copyrighted material. These works are made available to students through licensed databases or fair use. They are protected by copyright law, and may not be further disseminated or reproduced in any form for distribution (e.g., uploading to websites, sale, exchange, etc.) without permission of the copyright owner.

More information about intellectual property, copyright, and computer acceptable use can be found here:

<https://www1.villanova.edu/villanova/generalcounsel/copyright.html>
<https://www1.villanova.edu/dam/villanova/hr/documents/Intellectual%20Property%20Policy.pdf>
<https://www1.villanova.edu/villanova/unit/policies/AcceptableUse.html>
<https://www1.villanova.edu/villanova/unit/policies/AcceptableUse/copyright.html>

Dialogue in the Spirit of Solidarity

Students must engage one another with respect and in the spirit of true dialogue. We should feel free to disagree with one another, but always respectfully and without *ad hominem* attacks. No question or opinion warrants disparaging treatment. Questions are always welcome during the

class period and during office hours. We will learn much more during this course if we seriously consider one another's opinions and arguments in a careful and thoughtful manner.

N.B. THERE MAY BE PERIODIC ADJUSTMENTS TO THE FOLLOWING READING ASSIGNMENTS. THE INSTRUCTOR WILL INFORM YOU IN ADVANCE OF SUCH CHANGES.

Class Sessions/Topics

1/12 Introduction to the Course

*Timothy Garton Ash, "The Puzzle of Central Europe," *The New York Review of Books*, March 18, 1999 (12 pgs.),

<https://www.nybooks-com.ezpl.villanova.edu/articles/1999/03/18/the-puzzle-of-central-europe/>

Human Rights Watch, "Submission to the Universal Periodic Review of Poland," November 2022, <https://www.hrw.org/news/2022/08/19/submission-universal-periodic-review-poland> (5 pgs)

"Mothers of Srebrenica Still on Streets Demanding Justice," *Balkan Insight*, August 11, 2022, <https://balkaninsight.com/2022/08/11/mothers-of-srebrenica-still-on-streets-demanding-justice/> (1 pg.)

Timothy Snyder, "Putin Has Long Fantasized about a World without Ukrainians. Now We See What That Means," *The Washington Post*, March 23, 2022

<https://www.washingtonpost.com/opinions/2022/03/23/putin-genocide-language-ukraine-wipe-out-state-identity/> (2 pgs.)

View during Class: "Poland: We've Caught God by the Arm" from the series *A Force More Powerful*, <https://youtu.be/mD5xKALhnxg> (start at 27:05)

"Gdańsk w hołdzie prezydentowi Pawłowi Adamowiczowi,"

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5wbXQcts8no>

Recommended: Milan Kundera, "The Tragedy of Central Europe," *The New York Review of Books*, April 26, 1984 @

https://is.muni.cz/el/1423/jaro2016/MEB404/um/Kundera_1984.pdf

Olga Tokarczuk, "A Mayor Is Murdered, a Country Hums With Violence," *New York Times*, January 21, 2019, <https://tinyurl.com/yb7mox2v>

1/14 The War in Ukraine: History and Causes (Fishbowl/Podcast 1; 2 students)

Serhii Plokhy, “The Empire Strikes Back” and “The New Eastern Europe” in *The Frontline: Essays on Ukraine’s Past and Present* (Harvard University Press, 2021), <https://www-jstor-org.ezpl.villanova.edu/stable/j.ctv2902b86> (18 pgs)

Serhii Plokhy, “The Empire Returns: Russia, Ukraine and the Long Shadow of the Soviet Union,” *The Financial Times*, January 28, 2022, <http://ezproxy.villanova.edu.ezpl.villanova.edu/login?url=https://www-proquest-com.ezpl.villanova.edu/newspapers/empire-returns/docview/2633582811/se-2?accountid=14853> (3 pgs.)

Timothy Snyder, “The War in Ukraine Is a Colonial War,” *The New Yorker* @ <https://www.newyorker.com/news/essay/the-war-in-ukraine-is-a-colonial-war> (9 pgs.)

View in Class: <https://ucu.edu.ua/en/news/we-don-t-have-to-persuade-nowadays-that-russia-is-an-aggressor-it-s-make-no-sense-it-s-evident-yaroslav-hrytsak/>

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GGmMftNBPJI&list=PL_Z9mt0HJeskBM8nPMx5IMz-WulxN7Ypm&index=6&t=3400s (36:40 Lucy Minicozzi)

1/21 The War in Ukraine: Genocide (Fishbowl/Podcast 2; 2 students)

The Russian Federation’s Escalating Commission of Genocide in Ukraine: A Legal Analysis@ <https://newlinesinstitute.org/genocide/the-russian-federations-escalating-commission-of-genocide-in-ukraine-a-legal-analysis/>

1/26 The War in Ukraine: Just War, Just Peace and Nonviolent Responses (Podcast 3; 2 students)

Rectorate and Operating Group, Ukrainian Catholic University, Feb. 27, 2022, “The Danger of Nuclear Disaster – What Can We Do to Prevent It?” https://ucu.edu.ua/en/news/the-danger-of-nuclear-disaster-what-can-we-do-to-prevent-it/?fbclid=IwAR0yqVANCPg9FAO_yKECIgJphx__pPYZv5YvxtaxqJQiLei_JD_S7IsDZx4 (7 pgs.)

Paul J. Griffiths, “Endless Slaughter,” *Commonweal*, June 7, 2022 <https://www.commonwealmagazine.org/print/42224> (4 pgs.)

Ramon Luzzaraga The Ethics of a Just, Protracted Warin “Ukraine: What Ought to be Done?” (5pgs) @<https://politicaltheology.com/the-ethics-of-a-just-protracted-war/>

Marie Dennis, “Ukraine Shows We Must Reject the Possibility That War Can Be Just,” *National Catholic Reporter*, March 25, 2022,

<https://www.ncronline.org/news/opinion/ukraine-shows-we-must-reject-possibility-war-can-be-just> (3 pgs.)

View in Class: UCU Project, Little Stories of a Big War,
<https://ucu.edu.ua/en/cat/war-histories/> (Natalia Rybka-Parkhomenko)

1/28 The War in Ukraine: History and the Role of Religion (Podcast 4; 2 students)

The Synod of Bishops of the Ukrainian Greek Catholic Church in Ukraine issued the Letter on War and Just Peace in the Context of New Ideologies “Rescue the victims from the hand of their oppressors” (Jer. 22:3).

<https://ugcc.ua/en/data/rescue-the-victims-from-the-hand-of-their-oppressors-jer-223-the-letter-of-the-synod-of-bishops-of-the-ugcc-in-ukraine-on-war-and-just-peace-in-the-context-of-new-ideologies-944/>

Recommended:

Christine Karelska, “The Great Orthodox Battle Amid the Russian Invasion,” Visegrad Insight, June 23, 2022, <https://visegradinsight.eu/the-great-orthodox-battle-amid-the-russian-invasion/> (12 pgs.)

2/2 Poland under Communism/The Church under Communism (Podcast 5; 2 students)

Weigel, *The Final Revolution: The Resistance Church and the Collapse of Communism*, p.103-158.

Scenes from Andrzej Wajda, *Człowiek z marmuru* [Man of Marble] to be viewed in class (with English subtitles)

Recommended:

Davies, Norman. *God's Playground: A History of Poland, Volume II 1795 to the Present*, New York: Columbia Univ. Press, 1982, p. 556-633

Wedel, Janine R. *The Private Poland*. New York, NY: Facts on File Inc., 1986.

Milosz, Czesław. *The Captive Mind*. Vintage International ed. New York: Vintage International, 1990.

Tischner, Józef. *Marxism and Christianity: The Quarrel and the Dialogue in Poland*. Washington, D.C.: Georgetown University Press, 1987.

2/4 The Rise of Solidarity in 1980: Demographics of the Movement, Overview of Its Demands (Podcast 6; 2 students)

Beyer, *Recovering Solidarity*, Chapter 1

2/9 The Rise of Solidarity in 1980: Demographics of the Movement, Overview of Its Demands (Podcast 7; 2 students)

*Michnik, Adam. "The Moral and Spiritual Origins of Solidarity." In *Without Force or Lies: Voices from the Revolution of Central Europe in 1989-90*. ed. William M. Brinton and Alan Rinzler, San Francisco: Mercury House, 1990, p. 239-250.

*Excerpts from Shana Penn, *Solidarity's Secret: The Women who Defeated Communism in Poland* @ <https://babel.hathitrust.org/cgi/pt?id=mdp.39015060782524> (Intro. and Chapter 7, p. 226-241)

Recommended: Padraic Kenney, "The Gender of Resistance in Communist Poland," *The American Historical Review* 104:2 (April 1999): 399-425.

Stjerbo, Steinar. *Solidarity in Europe: The History of an Idea*. Cambridge: Cambridge University press, 2005, p. 60-89.

Pesch, Heinrich. *Heinrich Pesch on Solidarist Economics*. Lanham, Maryland: University Press of America, 1998, p. 86-88.

2/11 The Ethic of Solidarity in Poland (Podcast 8; 2 students)

*Tischner, Józef. *The Spirit of Solidarity*. San Francisco: Harper & Row, 1984, p. 44-59;

*Tischner, Józef, *The Ethics of Solidarity* (15pgs.)

*Popieluszko, Jerzy. *The Way of My Cross*. Chicago: Regnery Books, 1986, p. 158-68, 192-97, 225-30.

Recommended:

Gawin, Dariusz, @ http://www.tischner.org.pl/Content/Images/tischner_10_gawin.pdf (23pgs.)

Ciżewska-Martyńska, Elżbieta. "Interpretative Frames, Phenomenology, and the Question of the Republican Character of Polish and Czech Dissident Movements of the 1970s and 1980s', *East European Politics & Societies*, vol. 36, no. 3 (2022)867–891, <https://ezproxy-villanova-edu.ezpl.villanova.edu/login?URL=https://search-ebscohost-com.ezpl.villanova.edu/login.aspx?direct=true&db=hia&AN=158008760&site=ehost-live&scope=site>

Beyer, Gerald J. "A Theoretical Appreciation of the Ethic of Solidarity in Poland Twenty-five Years After," *Journal of Religious Ethics* Vol. 35, No. 2 (June 2007): 207-32 @ https://www-jstor.org.ezpl.villanova.edu/stable/40014867?seq=1#metadata_info_tab_contents

Zbigniew Herbert, "The Envoy of Mr. Cogito." In *Zbigniew Herbert: Selected Poems*, p. 94-97.

Andrzej Wajda, *Człowiek z żelaza* [Man of Iron]; with English subtitles

2/16 Roman Catholicism's Influence on the Solidarity Movement (No Podcast)

View during Class: Scenes from "Messenger of Truth"

2/18 Roman Catholicism's Influence on the Solidarity Movement (Podcast 9; 2 students)

Weigel, *The Final Revolution: The Resistance Church and the Collapse of Communism*, p. 77-102.

Recommended:

*Michnik, Adam. *The Church and the Left*. Chicago: Univ. of Chicago Press, 1993, p. 232-272.

Agnieszka Graff, "The Quagmire Effect. On the Special Role of the Catholic Church in Poland," *Heinrich Böll Foundation*, https://www.academia.edu/14834292/The_Quagmire_Effect_On_the_Special_Role_of_the_Catholic_Church_in_Poland_IN_Religion_Politics_and_Gender.2009_Heinrich_Boell_Foundation

John Paul II, *Laborem Exercens*. Available at:

http://www.vatican.va/content/john-paul-ii/en/encyclicals/documents/hf_jp-ii_enc_14091981_laborem-exercens.html

*Wnuk-Lipinski, Edmund, "Vicissitudes of Ethical Civil Society in Central and Eastern Europe," *Studies in Christian Ethics*, Vol. 20, No. 1 (2007): 30-43.

Dariusz Karłowicz, "Solidarity as Church" @

http://www.tischner.org.pl/Content/Images/tischner_11_karlowicz.pdf

John Paul II, *The Acting Person (Analecta Husserliana)*. Springer, 2002.

Micewski, Andrzej. *Cardinal Wyszyński: A Biography*. San Diego: Harcourt, Brace, Janovich, 1984

2/23 The Year 1989: The Historic Round Table, the Demise of Communism (Podcast 10; 2 students)

*Kennedy, Michael D. "Power, Privilege and Ideology in Communism's Negotiated Collapse." Available at:

<http://webapps.lsa.umich.edu/ii/polishroundtable/pdf/kennedy.pdf> (22 pgs.)

*Michnik, Adam. *Letters from Freedom: Post-Cold War Realities and Perspectives*. Berkeley: University of California Press, 1998, 117-131.

2/25 Economic, Social and Political Transformations (Podcast 11; 2 students))

*Kowalik, Tadeusz, *From Solidarity to Sellout: The Restoration of Capitalism in Poland*. New York. Monthly Review Press, 2011, 105-49

Segments of Poland from "Commanding Heights" to be viewed in class; links to Polandclips:

<http://www.pbs.org/wgbh/commandingheights/lo/countries/index.html>

Recommended:

*Sachs, Jeffrey. "Poland's Return to Europe" in *The End of Poverty: Economic Possibilities for Our Time*. New York: Penguin Press, 2005, 109-130.

MIDTERM PAPER DUE

3/9 The Decline of the Solidarity Movement and the Demise of its Program (Podcast 12; 2 students)

David Ost, *The Defeat of Solidarity*, 1-36

3/11 The Decline of the Solidarity Movement and the Demise of its Program (Podcast 13; 2 students)

David Ost, *The Defeat of Solidarity*, 37-60

Beyer, Gerald J. "What Ever Became of Solidarity?" *America* 194, no. 12 (2006): 11-14@ <https://www.americamagazine.org/issue/557/article/what-ever-became-solidarity>

3/16 The Decline of the Solidarity Movement and the Demise of its Program (Podcast 14; 2 students)

David Ost, *The Defeat of Solidarity*, 60-120

3/18 Poverty as a Symptom of the Decline of Solidarity (Podcast 15; 2 students)

Ost, *The Defeat of Solidarity*, 121-178

3/23 Poverty as a Symptom of the decline of Solidarity (Podcast 16; 2 students)

Beyer, *Recovering Solidarity* 56-96 middle

3/25 A Revitalized Ethic of Solidarity in Capitalist, Democratic Poland? (Podcast 17; 2 students)

*Michał Łuczewski et al. *Solidarity Step By Step*, 8-23; 108-165

View in Class: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LSb_huUCpw4 and <https://berkleycenter.georgetown.edu/events/love-and-forgiveness-in-governance> and

“The Father, The Son and The Friend” @ https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_0jDOx1WLN8

3/30 Guest Speaker, Michał Łuczewski

4/1 The War in Bosnia: the Breakdown of Solidarity among Serbs, Croats, and Bosnians (Podcast 18; 2 students)

Rusmir Mahmutćehajić, “The Achievement of Bosnia,” in *Learning from Bosnia: Approaching Tradition*. New York: Fordham University Press, 2005, pgs. 5-15. Available at

<http://ebookcentral.proquest.com/lib/villanova-ebooks/detail.action?docID=3239711>

Michael Anthony Sells. *The Bridge Betrayed: Religion and Genocide in Bosnia*. Berkeley: University of California Press, 1998, pgs. 1-70

Recommended: Benjamin Denison and Jasmin Mujanović, “Syria isn’t Bosnia. And no, the problem isn’t ‘ancient hatreds.’” *The Washington Post*, November 17, 2015 @ <https://tinyurl.com/y84vgxsa>

4/8 The War in Bosnia: the Breakdown of Solidarity among Serbs, Croats, and Bosnians (Podcast 19; 2 students)

Sells, *The Bridge Betrayed: Religion and Genocide in Bosnia*, pgs. 71-145

4/13 The War in Bosnia: the Breakdown of Solidarity among Serbs, Croats, and Bosnians (Podcast 20; 2 students)

Sells, *The Bridge Betrayed: Religion and Genocide in Bosnia*, pgs. 146-55

Rusmir Mahmutćehajić, *Sarajevo Essays: Politics, Ideology, and Tradition* (State University of New York Press, 2003), 83-99; 117-33 (Chs. 5 & 7). Available at <https://ebookcentral.proquest.com/lib/villanova-ebooks/detail.action?docID=3408440>

Recommended: Rusmir Mahmutćehajić, *Learning from Bosnia: Approaching Tradition*. New York: Fordham University Press, 2005. Available at <http://ebookcentral.proquest.com/lib/villanova-ebooks/detail.action?docID=3239711>

4/15 The Absence of International Solidarity in the Face of Genocide (Podcast 21; 2 students)

*“Bosnia” and “Srebrenica” in Samantha Power, *A Problem from Hell: America and the Age of Genocide* (New York: Perennial, 2002), 247-328, 391-442. Available at <https://hdl-handle-net.ezpl.villanova.edu/2027/fulcrum.47429948w>

ICISS, The Responsibility to Protect (Synopsis, XI-XIII), <http://responsibilitytoprotect.org/ICISS%20Report.pdf>

Steven Groves, “The U.S. Should Reject the U.N. ‘Responsibility to Protect’ Doctrine,” <https://www.heritage.org/report/the-us-should-reject-the-un-responsibility-protect-doctrine>

4/20 Guest Speaker, Elma Beslic, Youth For Peace, Bosnia-Herzegovina

4/22 Solidarity and Peacebuilding in Bosnia and Herzegovina after the War (Podcast 22; 2 students)

Spahic-Siljak, Zilka. (2015). “Women, Religion and Peace Leadership in Bosnia and Herzegovina” pp. 5-7 only @ https://www.researchgate.net/publication/324164458_Women_Religion_and_Peace_Leadership_in_Bosnia_and_Herzegovina

Zilka Spahić Šiljak, *Shining Humanity: Life Stories of Women in Bosnia and Herzegovina* (Cambridge Scholars, 2014), xiii-xxxvi; 3-38; 107-140 (Intro., Chs. 1 and 4). Available at <https://ebookcentral.proquest.com/lib/villanova-ebooks/detail.action?docID=1790937>

Recommended: Zilka Spahić Šiljak, “Women Citizens and Believers as Agents of Peace in Bosnia and Herzegovina” in Susan Hayward and Katherine Marshall, eds. *Women, Religion, and Peacebuilding: Illuminating the Unseen* (U. S. Institute of Peace, 2015)

4/27 Solidarity and Peacebuilding in Bosnia and Herzegovina after the War (Podcast 23: 3 students)

Soeren Keil & Anastasiia Kudlenko, “Bosnia and Herzegovina 20 Years after Dayton: Complexity Born of Paradoxes, International Peacekeeping,” 22:5 (2015): 471-485; Available @ <https://www-tandfonline-com.ezpl.villanova.edu/doi/pdf/10.1080/13533312.2015.1103651>

Eleonora Emkic, “Peace Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina” (37-49) and “Conclusion” (83-106 RECOMMENDED ONLY) in *Reconciliation and Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina* (Springer, 2018); Available at <https://link-springer-com.ezpl.villanova.edu/book/10.1007%2F978-3-319-73034-9>

4/29 Solidarity and Peacebuilding in Bosnia and Herzegovina after the War (Podcast 24: 3 students)

Hazim Fazlić, “Perspectives on Building Trust among Communities in Bosnia and Herzegovina: The Challenges and the Role of Faith Communities,” *Journal of Ecumenical Studies*, vol. 50, no 2, Spr 2015, pgs. 325-41 <https://muse-jhu-edu.ezpl.villanova.edu/article/588413>

Catholic Relief Services, “Bosnia and Herzegovina National Government Adopts Roadmap...” and “Inspired by Pope Francis, New Master’s Program on Interreligious Studies...” @ <https://www.crs.org/media-center/news-release/inspired-pope-francis-new-masters-program-interreligious-studies-and-peacebuilding>

Wesley K. Clark, “Don’t Wait for the Western Balkans to Blow Up Again. The U.S. and the E.U. Must Act.” *The Washington Post*, April 11, 2018 @ <http://tinyurl.com/yy74ba3d>

Recommended:

Srečko Latal, “Serb Leader’s War Drums Stir New Fears in Bosnia,” *Balkan Insight*, April 16, 2019 @ <https://balkaninsight.com/2019/04/16/serb-leaders-war-drums-stir-new-fears-in-bosnia/>

Appendix: Standards for Teaching TRS Upper Division Courses (Department of Theology and Religious Studies, Revised May 2017)

Goal 1

Gain an understanding of the purposes, central issues, and methods of inquiry standard in theological and religious studies as applied to faith engaging culture.

Objective A

Analyze fundamental issues that frame theological and religious inquiry using appropriate scholarly methods, with attention to diversity and inclusion within the issues.

Objective B

Use critical methods to read, analyze, and interpret diverse religious and theological texts (e.g., women, minorities, non-western) and related genres or media, art, and artifacts (e.g., prayer, mystical writings, autobiographies, film, music).

Goal 2

Engage Christianity, with attention to Roman Catholicism, as a living tradition of practices and beliefs that continues to be refined, developed, and extended through time in diverse cultural contexts.

Objective A

Demonstrate understanding of the unique vocabulary, foundational sources, theological beliefs, historical developments, and diverse thinkers in the Christian tradition, with attention to those that reflect on the experiences of power, privilege, and marginalization.

Objective B

Articulate how Christian practices and beliefs reciprocally interact with diverse cultural contexts, local and global.

Goal 3

Render theological concepts and religious practices and beliefs intelligible, meaningful, and relevant in contemporary cultural contexts as a basis for transformative action in the world, in dialogue with others.

Objective A

Recognize the complexity and diversity of religious practices and beliefs and seek to understand people whose values and senses of the sacred differ from their own.

Objective B

Evaluate the relevance of theology/religion for personal, communal, societal, and global living.

Student:

Fishbowl Assessment	20 points each
You write and submit to the Blackboard Discussion Board (by noon the day before you lead) a focused summary of the main argument and supportive points of the text, referring to the author(s) by name (3-5 sentences).	
You write and submit by email (by 2PM before the day you lead) at least two carefully crafted questions. Questions should be 1) complex (not binary – that is, not calling for a simple yes/no or agree/disagree response). 2) contextualized, and 3) of different types. To contextualize your questions, offer a sentence or two that reflects on some aspect of the text and shows where your question is coming from.	
The group communicates the central argument or ideas of the text(s) they are discussing. This may be done through a brief summary statement or, more preferably, in an opening conversation or in questions that seek to clarify the author's meaning.	
The group helps us to see what is at stake in the question of the text(s) or how it is relevant for us in class today. Constructive and courteous disagreement is an excellent tool for this purpose.	
The conversation flows well, feels organic rather than artificial, and uses the time well.	
Total:	